

CLUE & CANDLE GAMES PRESENTS

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The Last *Countdown*

A Cozy New Year's Eve Murder Mystery Party Game

6-16 PLAYERS

2.5-3 HOURS

PRINTABLE PDF

Timed to end at midnight · 12 character booklets · Letter + A4



CLUE & CANDLE GAMES COZY · NO GORE · NO DRINKING REQUIRED

Start here



Welcome to **The Last Countdown**. Everything you need for a cozy New Year's Eve murder mystery for 6–16 players is in this download, in two identical folders: **US-Letter** and **A4**. Use the one that matches your paper.

FILE	WHAT IT IS	WHO GETS IT
00 Start Here	This file	You
01 Host Guide	Checklists, casting, two timetables, Scripts 1–4, tips	You
02 Invitations	12 character invitations + general version + text version	Each guest
03 Cast List	Public profiles of every character	Evidence table
10–21 Booklets	One 4-page booklet per character	One guest each
22 All Booklets	All 12 booklets in one file	Optional
30 Evidence Cards	12 cards, backs, blank cards	Evidence table
31 Name Tags	13 named tags + 3 blank	Everyone
32 Ballots	4 per page	Everyone
33 Detective Notes	Suspect table + timeline	Each guest
34 Awards & Signs	3 awards, 2 table signs	Optional
35 Clock & Decor	Countdown clock, Chime Cards, banner, props	You
99 SOLUTION	The answer and Script 5	You, at 11:45 pm

DO NOT OPEN FILE 99

File 99 holds the answer. Print it last, without reading, and keep it folded until the reveal. No other file names the guilty party.

Printing order

01 → 02 (or E-Invites) → booklets 10–21 (single-sided, one per guest) → 30 → 31 → 32 → 33 → 35 → 34 → 99 last. Booklets print single-sided so later rounds never show through; you can also cut each booklet's page 3 along the dashed line and hand out Round 2 separately.

Players, characters and pages



PLAYERS	CHARACTERS
6	Core six: booklets 10–15
7–12	Core six + optional 16, 17, 18 ... in order
13	All 12 + Deputy Detective (no booklet)
14–16	All 12 + Deputy + 1 to 3 pairs sharing optional booklets

How many pages to print

FILE	6 PLAYERS	8 PLAYERS	10 PLAYERS	12 PLAYERS	16 PLAYERS
01 Host Guide (all pages)	16	16	16	16	16
99 Solution	5	5	5	5	5
03 Cast List	3	3	3	3	3
Booklets 10–21 (4 pages each)	24	32	40	48	60
02 Invitations	3	4	5	6	8
30 Evidence Cards (pages 1–2)	2	2	2	2	2
31 Name Tags	1	2	2	2	3
32 Ballots	2	2	3	3	4
33 Detective Notes (1 each)	6	8	10	12	16
35 Clock + Chime Cards (pages 1–2)	2	2	2	2	2
Total pages	64	76	88	99	119

16 players: 12 booklets + 3 extra copies for pairs; invitation page 7 (general) printed twice; name-tag page 2 printed twice. Optional extras not counted: 22 (48 pages), 30 pages 3–4, 34 (5 pages), 35 pages 3–5, and E-Invites (no printing).

Questions and answers



QUESTION	ANSWER
How many players?	6 to 16 guests, plus you as the Detective. Six core characters are always used; six optional ones join as your list grows.
How long does it take?	Midnight Edition: 9:00 pm to 12:00 am, ending with the countdown. Family Early Countdown: 6:30 to 9:00 pm.
Can the host play?	Yes. You play Detective Rowan Hale, run the timeline and read the scripts. You learn the answer at the reveal with everyone else.
Is it family and work friendly?	Yes. It is a cozy mystery: no gore, no swearing, and no drinking is needed. Drinks in the story are punch, cider and cocoa.
Are the roles gender-specific?	No. All twelve characters work for anyone.
Black-and-white printer?	Fine. Every page is designed for greyscale; evidence rounds are marked with stars.
Can I reuse it?	Yes, for your own parties, as often as you like. Please don't share or resell the files.
Something missing or wrong?	Reply to your order email and we will help, or request a refund within 14 days.

HOW THIS GAME WAS MADE

The story, characters and clues were written with the help of AI tools, then edited, fact-checked for fairness (every clue in the solution is printed in the evidence or booklets) and laid out by Clue & Candle Games.

All characters, places and events are fictional. © Clue & Candle Games. Personal use licence.